

15 : ABORIGINES AND THE NORTHERN TERRITORY

CATTLE INDUSTRY — AN ECONOMIST'S VIEW

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I cannot claim that these comments are based on a thorough knowledge or a deep understanding of Australian Aborigines. Apart from the usual casual contacts on many visits to Australian country towns, my acquaintance with problems of Aborigines consists of a three week trip to the Alice Springs — Barkly Tablelands — Tennant Creek areas of the Northern Territory; of visits to about 25 cattle stations in these districts, to three Government settlements for Aborigines (that is, Papunya, Yendumu and Warrabri) and of discussions with many cattlemen, with officers of the Welfare Branch of the Northern Territory Administration, with a few missionaries and even fewer Aborigines. Last, but not least, I have benefited from many discussions and arguments with Colin Tatz and Frank Stevens who shared the same Land Rover, and many of the same general attitudes, even though a basic residue of disagreement between our views probably still remains.

Anyone who has seen the general level of Aboriginal housing and amenities which prevail on the outskirts of many country towns in southern Australia is unlikely to take at face value the neat, tidy bungalows and the well-scrubbed, happy black faces which adorn the covers of the many public relations pamphlets of the Department of Territories. But little I had seen in New South Wales country towns prepared me for the humpies, the destitution and the general air of despondency among Aborigines on cattle stations and even some Government settlements in the Northern Territory. It is true that there were some exceptions where Aborigines lived in neater galvanised iron or aluminium huts; even there though, the almost total lack of personal possessions and the absence of any form of purposeful activity was extremely depressing.

RAISING MINIMUM WAGES

The traditional Australian technique for raising incomes of wage earners is to increase the minimum award payments which employers must pay. Subject to some important reservations, discussed later, this is the course which has been adopted by the Arbitration Commission in its recent judgment dealing with the wages of Aborigines employed in the cattle industry in the Northern Territory.

The cattle industry award case is of considerable interest, because of the increasing concern about Aborigines' living standards, because it shows the difficulties of an industrial tribunal confronted with evidence virtually from one party only and lastly, because it shows up some of the limitations of this traditional technique for raising living standards.

The case was initiated by the North Australian Workers' Union which sought to bring full-blood Aborigines within the *Cattle Station Industry (Northern Territory) Award*. This award provides for weekly payments of £11.5.10 to general station hands, a margin of 10/- a week for stockmen and somewhat larger margins for other employees on cattle stations. This award is considerably below award wages for broadly comparable grades of urban workers in Darwin and for the same positions in the cattle industry in Queensland. Among the non-Aboriginal workers employed on the stations we visited, few, if any, workers were paid as little as the award. Wages for stockmen — the category most closely comparable to that in which the bulk of Aborigines are employed — ranged from £17 to £23 a week. However, jackaroos — i.e. persons training to become overseers, managers, etc. — received considerably less, namely between £5 and £14 a week. In addition every station visited provided free food and lodgings for its European employees.

Prior to the recent judgment, the conditions of employment for most full-blood Aborigines in the Northern Territory were laid down in the *Wards' Employment Ordinance*. The wages payable under this Ordinance for general work on cattle stations amounted to £2.8.3 for adult males plus a clothing allowance of 15/- a week plus keep. We obtained details of pay to Aboriginal workers on 27 cattle stations. At the time of our visit (in May-June 1965), these stations employed a total of 370 adult male Aborigines. Of these 3 per cent were paid less than £3 a week, 51 per cent were paid between £3 and £4 a week, 34 per cent between £4 and £6 a week and 11 per cent received

more than £6 a week. (These figures do not include annual bonuses averaging £200 paid on one cattle station employing four full-blood Aborigines and two part-Aborigines.)

THE COMMISSION'S VISITS TO CATTLE STATIONS

The Union, as the applicant in the case, sought to have the case argued and decided as a matter of principle and without evidence, whilst the employers submitted that the Commission could not decide the issue properly unless it inspected properties in the Territory and heard, and saw, evidence as to the quality of Aboriginal labour from station owners and managers.

The Commission acceded to the employers' request, visited six cattle stations and heard detailed evidence from managements of thirty other stations.

Judging from the cattle stations we visited, the six stations inspected by the Commission are about as unrepresentative as any six that one could find in the Territory. We also visited the three stations in the Alice Springs district which were inspected by the Commission. The first, Narwietooma, is owned by Mr. E. J. Connellan of Connellan Airways. Whilst Mr. Connellan was not too co-operative when we first contacted him ('Quite frankly, I came up here to get away from bastards like you' was his initial greeting when we arrived at Narwietooma), he did agree to provide us with information about his property two days later. The wages paid to Aborigines by Connellan were the highest paid by any of the cattle stations we visited. Nap-erby, the second station in the Alice Springs district inspected by the Commission, had the best housing conditions for Aborigines of any of the stations we visited in the Alice Springs area and Aboriginal rates of pay were the second highest in the district. Hamilton Downs, the third station visited, also provided conditions which were well above average. In the Barkly Tablelands district the Commission inspected Brunette Downs, Alexandria and Brunchilly. Of these Brunchilly is one of the very few stations of its size which does not employ Aborigines¹, and Alexandria has recently spent £21,000 on accommodation and water supplies for 45 employed Aborigines and their families; this would be four to ten times as much per Aboriginal employee as spent by most other station managements. (Aboriginal wages on Alexandria are also above the

1. Colin Tatz states that Brunchilly has had labour problems with Aborigines since 1960 and that its exclusive use of white labour is a matter of expediency and not choice.

district average.) In other words, four out of the five cattle stations employing Aborigines provided conditions of employment which were unusually good by Northern Territory cattle industry standards.

It is perhaps puzzling that neither the Commonwealth Government — which intervened in the case — nor the Union should have pressed the Commission to visit other stations as well. The Commonwealth Government's attitude in this matter was perhaps bound to be somewhat ambivalent since it lays down certain minimum standards of Aboriginal housing, wages, rations, clothing and working conditions on cattle stations in the *Wards' Employment Ordinance*. These have by no means been fully enforced. There is evidence that the Administration has not — at least between 1959 and March 1964, prosecuted any cattle station for failure to comply with any of the regulations. In as far as we could tell, only three or four of the thirty stations we contacted would meet the minimum requirements laid down. It should be pointed out that the lack of conformity to minimum standards of accommodation was freely admitted by the employers during the hearing. It was pointed out that many stations were awaiting the outcome of the Aboriginal wage case before committing themselves to further expenditure. On the other hand, the regulations establishing minimum housing standards were established in 1959.

The Union's motivation is somewhat more puzzling. Its inactivity in the matter is probably attributable to its almost total lack of knowledge of the conditions under which Aborigines work on individual stations. The N.A.W.U. secretary informed the other two members of our group that some time ago the Union had to stop inspections of conditions on cattle stations through lack of funds. As far as we could ascertain, only one of the stations we visited had ever been contacted by a Union organiser — and that was five years earlier.

THE PRODUCTIVITY OF ABORIGINAL LABOUR

The employers did not oppose the application of the award to a limited number of Aboriginal employees who were 'capable of carrying out the full range of duties normally required' of stockmen, etc. They estimated that this category would amount to 20-25 per cent of the total number of full-blood Aborigines currently employed by the industry. The remaining Aboriginal employees were to be paid amounts ranging from 30 per cent

to 70 per cent of the award, depending on their respective ability to carry out different proportions of 'the full range of duties normally required'.

The Commonwealth Government supported the Union's case in principle, subject to two provisos. It asked for a deferment of the implementation of the Union's claim for a period of years and the introduction of transitional arrangements which would lead to the gradual introduction of full award rates and conditions.

The employers repeatedly emphasised that their claim for wages below the award level was based not on racial grounds but on work value. They argued that, mainly for cultural reasons and lack of education, the average productivity of Aboriginal labour was considerably below that of white labour. They also drew attention to the unsatisfactory employment record of Aborigines in other industries in the Northern Territory. Of a total Northern Territory full-blood Aboriginal population of about 20,000, only 132 appeared to be on award wages at the time of the hearing. Of these, 77 Aborigines were employed at award wages by the Government, including 34 in municipal work (mainly garbage collection) in Alice Springs and Darwin.

Three pieces of evidence, in particular, were tendered about the employment experience of full-blood Aborigines outside the cattle industry. The first concerned the attempt to introduce Aboriginal labour at full award rates on the Darwin waterfront. The conditions for their introduction were favourable; the employers, the Union, the Australian Stevedoring Industry Authority, were willing to co-operate, as were rank and file members of the Union. The wages to be earned were very much higher than those Aborigines could otherwise expect to receive. Yet the experiment was obviously a failure; only 17 Aborigines were registered as waterside workers; by 1965 only one remained, the rest having been de-registered because of their poor working record and frequent absenteeism. Similar evidence was cited by the pastoralists from recent attempts to use Aboriginal labour in abattoirs in Katherine and Darwin. With the sole exception of Groote Eylandt (where 24 Aborigines are employed at award rates) the mining industry has not employed any sizeable number of Aborigines, although some managements have been prepared to do so (for example, the Peko Mine at Tennant Creek where two Aborigines are employed on award wages out of a total work force of 300).

Turning specifically to the productivity of Aboriginal labour

on cattle stations, the employers argued that most Aborigines were, on balance, less productive than white labour because of cultural and tribal factors. In particular it was argued that Aborigines had no real concept of work, required constant supervision, were unable to follow any but the simplest instructions. The employers introduced some evidence from the anthropological writings of Professor Elkin and others, and articles based on ethno-psychiatric studies of Aborigines in settlements. The burden of all this evidence was that Aborigines do not work as well or as consistently as whites and that they require much more supervision. Neither the Union nor the Government introduced any evidence on this point, relying exclusively on a criticism of the evidence called by the pastoralists. In the view of the Commission, 'the criticism of the evidence produced by the pastoralists is no more than minimal. Generally speaking, we accept the uncontradicted evidence given by pastoralists as to the work value of the Aborigines, supported as it was by what we saw ourselves and by the anthropological and other material.'

On this point, some questions which we asked our sample of cattlemen are of relevance. We asked firstly about past employment trends and whether, if the respondents could get sufficient suitable white labour, they would replace their existing Aboriginal labour force. This was followed by three questions which should be discussed in some detail. The first was: 'In your opinion, are Aborigines more valuable and productive workers than whites?' Ten respondents felt that Aborigines were definitely not as productive as whites, five believed that by and large they were not as productive, though they regarded Aborigines as superior in some respects, fourteen could be classified as giving qualified affirmative answers, that is, that on balance Aborigines were more productive than whites, though there were some obvious deficiencies in the work performance of Aborigines. (One respondent felt they were of equal value.²) Our next question was: 'If you feel Aborigines fall short of the mark, can you say why and in what respects?' All respondents had some comments here, the most frequent being that Aborigines needed constant supervision (thirteen respondents) although five qualified this, sometimes significantly (for example, they need good supervision then you can't beat them). Two other relatively common complaints were irresponsibility or

2. Partly because there may be some interest in the individual answers to questions and partly because it is impossible to avoid a minimum element of arbitrariness in classifying answers, the appendix to this paper gives the individual answers to the three questions quoted in the text.

disinterestedness (ten respondents — including two qualified responses) and unreliability (seven, including one qualified response).

The last question in this area was: 'If you feel Aborigines superior in value and productivity, can you say why and in what respects?' The vast majority of cattlemen (24 out of 29) could think of some respects in which Aborigines were superior. These related mainly to stock work (seven respondents, including four qualified), tracking (again seven, including three qualified answers), knowledge of the local country (five, with one qualification), general bushmanship (three respondents) and many other individual comments.

The general conclusion which emerges from these answers seems to me to be that while Aboriginal labour on Northern Territory cattle stations is in some obvious and important respects less productive than white labour, there are other respects, perhaps equally important, in which Aboriginal labour is generally regarded as being superior to white labour. Between two-thirds and three-quarters of all adult male Aborigines employed on cattle stations were employed directly on cattle work — for example, as stockmen, leading hands, etc. Their relatively greater skill in stock work and bushmanship would be of considerable importance in these occupations.

It is not surprising that the Commission accepted the evidence of the pastoralists 'supported as it was by what we saw ourselves'. While the illiteracy and the need for supervision would be evident to the casual visitor to a cattle station, the superior bushmanship and tracking ability of Aborigines would not. Further, the casual visitor cannot hope to see Aboriginal labour at work on stations of 500 square miles and more, nor can he judge their 'productiveness' in periods of drought or in seasonal periods of general non-activity on stations. At most, the casual half-day or one-day visitor can see a collection of Aborigines gathered around the immediate confines of the homestead — a gathering which gives the impression of lack of purpose and lack of work.

THE POTENTIAL DISPLACEMENT OF LABOUR

The pastoralists argued that the application of award rates to Aborigines would cause massive disemployment. The Government and the Union, on the other hand, suggested that disemployment would be relatively minor.

Displacement of Aborigines could occur in two ways: (a) cattlemen could replace Aborigines with white labour or (b) station owners could invest in improvements such as trap yards and sub-divisional fencing which would reduce the amount of labour needed for tracking and mustering.

It was suggested that employers would have difficulty finding suitable white labour. When we asked our survey group whether they could get sufficient white labour, fifteen replied that they could, whilst nine maintained that they could not. The minority would contain most of the smaller cattle stations; personally I believe that none of the larger stations (or companies with stations in various parts of Australia) would experience much difficulty in recruiting sufficient white labour if they made a determined attempt to do so. The evidence introduced on this point by the employers seems to me pretty conclusive. (However, I should record that at least one of my colleagues disagrees with this view.)

There is also the substitution of structural improvements and capital equipment (for example, in the form of vehicles and/or aircraft) for labour. This is a trend which is normal in a developing economy where labour is all the time becoming relatively more expensive (compared to machinery, equipment and structures); it is also occurring in the rest of Australia (both in industry and in agriculture). On grounds of technical, agricultural efficiency a case could be made out for stimulating such developmental expenditure on cattle stations in the Northern Territory, since additional sub-divisional fencing would allow for improvements in the management of both the cattle population and the vegetation and pastures.

However, in as far as we are concerned with the fate of the Aboriginal labour force, it must be admitted, I think, that a substantial increase in the wages payable to Aborigines is likely to lead to displacement of Aboriginal labour. Some indication of the extent of the displacement can be obtained from the answers we got to the following questions:

'How many of your present Aboriginal workers do you consider worth an award wage?' The 29 station owners or managers answering this question employed 415 adult male Aborigines; they considered that 77 (or about 19 per cent) were 'worth' an award wage. This proportion is similar to the employers' submission that from 20 to 25 per cent of Aborigines now employed on cattle stations are worth the current Northern Territory award wage. It might be added that less than 5 per cent

of the Aboriginal labour force at present gets the equivalent of an award wage. To the next question: 'How many Aborigines would you keep on the property in the event of equal wages being granted?' the same respondents gave a much higher figure — namely 164 — that is, about 40 per cent of the current adult male Aboriginal labour force on these properties.

These two sets of answers are by no means as inconsistent as they might appear at first sight. Station managers may be prepared to keep more Aborigines than they believe are worth an award wage at the moment because they would work an award wage labour force harder and more efficiently. There certainly appeared to be a great deal of hidden unemployment in the present system of managing Aboriginal labour. Apart from the cattle camp where little feather-bedding is tolerated, we only visited one station where all coloured employees seemed to go about their tasks with a sense of purpose and application. This extravagant use of labour is partly the result of its low cost to management.

Just how many Aborigines would be displaced by an all round application of award wages, is a very difficult question to answer — even for those who are operating the stations. On balance, I am inclined to believe that the station owners and managers we interviewed probably under-estimated the number they would employ on awards. This does not necessarily imply any effort on the part of the respondents to deceive us; but is partly related to the order in which the questions were asked. There could easily be some belief that the answers given to these two consecutive questions should not diverge too widely. Some partial support for this view is obtained from a follow-up questionnaire sent to the respondents some six months after our visit; a question on the amount of likely disemployment in this second survey produced a somewhat smaller figure than our original query.³

However, the introduction of award wages for all Aborigines would undoubtedly lead to some reduction in the level of employment of Aborigines in the cattle industry — below the levels of employment which would otherwise obtain.⁴

3. There is clearly a difference between asking a man an 'attitude' question, viz., what will you do, or what would you do, and an 'action' question, will you really do it when the crunch comes? We asked 'theory' questions and to some extent 'practice' questions: we must leave room, or allow room, for their *real* behaviour.
4. There are some reasons why one might argue that the actual level of employment will not in fact fall — or will fall considerably less than they would in a static situation. These are: (a) the number of Aborigines

THE COMMISSION'S JUDGMENT

The Commission's judgment can be discussed under three headings:

(a) *Granting award wages.* Firstly the Commission decided that 'considerations of overwhelming industrial justice requires us to put Aboriginal employees in the Northern Territory on to the same basis as white employees. The law which prevails for white employees in the industry should also prevail for Aborigines.' On these grounds the Commission decided that the provisions of the award should be extended to Aborigines.

(b) *Delaying introduction of award.* However, the Commission delayed the introduction of award wages for Aborigines by almost three years. The justification given was as follows:

Although we firmly believe that the time has come when Aborigines are entitled to award protection we wish to be practical about the results of our decision. We must give everyone concerned time to adjust and rearrange their activities so that the introduction of the award will occur as smoothly as possible and with as little dislocation, social and economic, to everyone concerned and in particular to the Aborigines themselves. The introduction of award coverage for Aborigines will therefore come into operation on 1st December, 1968, which will give everyone ample time to deal with the various practical matters involved. This date was chosen by us because it is the beginning of a month approximately three years from the end of the hearing, and it is between musterings on most properties. The intervening period will also enable the parties to give consideration to the terms of the current award, including questions such as accommodation and rations which may require changes when Aborigines are covered by the award.

Apparently considerations of practicality must take precedence over considerations of 'overwhelming social justice'—at least for a period of three years. Do the wheels of industrial justice normally grind so slowly? Since the employers do not dispute that a sizeable proportion (20-25 per cent) of the Aboriginal

in pastoral and agricultural areas fell by 27½ per cent between December 1963 and June 1965. This was mainly the result of the drought conditions in Central Australia. This drought has now broken and the demand for labour from Centralian cattle stations is likely to rise as a result. (b) The cattle industry in the northern parts of the Territory is at present passing through a period of boom and expansion, with consequent increases in the demand for labour. This is due to the high prices received for beef on world markets, the improved roads provided by the Federal Government and the establishment of two abattoirs in Darwin and Katherine.

In other words in the absence of an award, one might expect a substantial increase in the demand for labour.

work force on cattle stations is sufficiently productive to warrant an award wage at present, and that few of these Aborigines are in fact obtaining wages of this magnitude, what is the possible justification for such an inordinate delay for this particular group? The main justification given by the Commission is that

the Commonwealth Government has power to deal with wages, working conditions, welfare and all other matters which may call for consideration during this transition period. We consider that in the period between now and the date when the award will operate it would be in the interests of all concerned if one authority dealt with all problems which may arise, including wages, accommodation, rations and keep.

It remains to be seen whether the Commonwealth Government takes any action to raise wages in the interim, either on cattle stations or on settlements and missions.

(c) *Extension of 'slow worker' provisions.* Being concerned with the dangers of substantial disemployment, the Commission felt that it should make some provisions which would enable sizeable numbers of Aborigines whose productivity is low, to be employed at below award rates. Under its Act, the Arbitration Commission is empowered 'to provide for the payment of wages at a lower rate for an employee who is unable to earn the minimum wage'. Many awards contain provisions known as slow worker clauses, which provide for this type of situation for a few individual workers who, for a variety of reasons (usually due to age or physical disability) are unable to earn the minimum wage. At an earlier part in its judgment the Commission drew attention to the difference between the normal type of slow worker clause and the employers' submission in these words:

If the facts were that Aborigines were covered by this award and there were only a few of them, the employers' problem might have been resolved by seeking slow workers' permits for the Aborigines concerned. But the fact is that the Aborigines for whom employers seek a rate lower than the award rate are in considerable numbers. The Commission has to contemplate the extension from individual employees to classes of employees of the principles applying to slow workers . . . it would be a big step to make a prescription for classes instead of individuals.

The Commission does not take this step, but at a later stage it argues that:

In our view the disemployment problem might be partly solved if the slow workers' clause were made more workable and less cumbersome than it is at the present time.

The Commission therefore requests the parties, 'including the Commonwealth Government, to consider an appropriate form of slow workers' clause which would enable a slow workers' permit to be obtained more easily than at present' and draws attention to a similar clause in the *Aluminium Industry Award*.

The main criticisms which must be made of this widening of the slow workers' provision are two-fold. Firstly, it nibbles away at the Commission's earlier ruling that there should be one law for both white and coloured employees in the industry. Secondly, the administration of slow workers' clauses lend themselves to abuse. Unless some reasonably objective test—such as age or physical disability—is used as the criterion of work value, it is difficult to see how the slow workers' clause can be administered justly to the individual employees. It was suggested earlier that an important skill of Aborigines employed in the cattle industry consisted of their ability to find and handle cattle. It is hard to see how a tribunal could assess their skills in this field without very exhaustive and time-consuming enquiries. It is hoped that the phrase 'cultural handicap' will not be used as a blanket justification for a slow worker classification.

Fears about the manner in which this clause might be administered are heightened when one remembers the lack of enforcement of housing standards of the *Wards' Employment Ordinance* referred to earlier. Nor is lack of enforcement confined to housing standards: the ration scales of the Ordinance were also broken on many stations we visited, without any prosecutions (as far as I am aware).

CONCLUSION

While I can find no justification for the long delay in granting award wages, it must be admitted that the Commission was faced with a difficult and unenviable task. On the one hand it wanted to obtain equality of treatment for Aboriginal and white employees; on the other it wanted to minimise disemployment. These aims are, to some extent, in conflict. The Commission attempted to steer a middle course; what the net result of the Arbitration Commission's judgment will be is uncertain and will depend on the administration of the slow workers' clause. What proportion of Aborigines will be classified as 'slow workers'? It seems likely that if the employers' views are accepted, between 75 and 80 per cent of the present Aboriginal labour forces on cattle stations will be so designated. However,

the answers given to our questions suggest that considerably more than 20-25 per cent of the Aborigines employed would be retained in the industry if award wages were paid to them.

One point stressed throughout the hearing and again referred to in the Commission's judgment was the need for more training and education of Aborigines. Most Aborigines in the Northern Territory will ultimately need to find employment outside the cattle industry. Obvious candidates would be the tourist industry (especially in Central Australia), mining and public works (for example, road building). As pointed out earlier, very little has been achieved in these areas so far. Two-thirds of the full-blood Aborigines in the Territory live in Government run settlements and on missions. According to the Government's annual report on the Northern Territory, one of the main purposes of settlements and mission stations is to 'provide the means whereby training may be given, particularly to children and adolescents'. As shown with devastating clarity during the cross-examination of the Director of Welfare by the counsel for the employers, most of the so-called training is not training in the sense in which this word is normally used.⁵ It is training which goes on and on and on, and never leads to a job. Most of the cattlemen we interviewed were extremely critical of the training for stock-work which Aborigines received on settlements. In other words, settlement training is often a euphemism for relief.

Nor are most young full-blood Aborigines on settlements and missions at present being educated to the level necessary for *unskilled* jobs in the community. According to an estimate made by a senior Northern Territory educational officer, 25 per cent of Aborigines now leaving school could read a newspaper. (My colleagues and I felt this to be an over-estimate, but even if it is a true assessment of the situation it does not augur well for the majority.) While we were not specifically inquiring about the educational progress of Aborigines, it was very obvious that a tremendous educational gap separates whites and full-blood Aborigines in the Northern Territory. There are two parallel state school systems. The first contains 5,400 pupils who are mainly white and part-Aboriginal.⁶ Total expenditure (for 1964-65) for these children amounted to £1,030,447 (including

5. *Commonwealth Conciliation and Arbitration Commission*, No. 830 of 1965, pp. 1648-1651.

6. The exact numbers are Europeans 4,162, Asians 181, part-Aborigines 899, Aborigines 169. None of the full-blood Aborigines have reached secondary school standards although 19 of the 169 are over 13 years of age.

£354,511 for new buildings) and they followed the South Australian school curriculum. The second system of special schools is administered by the Welfare Branch. It had 3,398 pupils at June 30th 1965 (all but 61 of these were full-blood Aborigines). As far as I could ascertain, the specific expenditure on education services by the Welfare Branch amounted to £60,114 for 1964-65 (having been cut from £65,083 for 1963-64!). However, this does not include teachers' salaries. On the basis of the 1964-65 report of the Northern Territory, it is possible to work out that the expenditure on teachers' salaries would have ranged between £111,178 and £171,704. Even if we take the higher figure there is no doubt that expenditure per pupil in the special schools is only a fraction of the level reached in the normal school system.

In a recent speech in the Federal Parliament, Mr. W. C. Wentworth stressed the need for discrimination *in favour* of Aborigines to help them to adjust to modern society and to earn a living in our economy. So far we have not even managed to treat them equally.

APPENDIX

Answers to Questions 5, 6 and 7

No. of Station	5. In your opinion, are Aborigines more valuable and productive workers than whites?	6. If you feel that Aborigines fall short of the mark, can you say why and in what respects?	7. If you feel Aborigines superior in value and productivity, can you say why and in what respects?
I	Yes, in some respects — e.g., ability to track is superior.	Require constant supervision — in which case they work as well.	Yes, in relation to tracking.
II	No.	Less reliable, need more constant supervision.	No.
III	Not in general, but superior in mustering and bushmanship.	Need supervision all the time.	Only in mustering and bushmanship.
IV	Yes, as stockmen.	On mechanical side.	Yes — as bushmen. Better on stock work. Also whites want to knock-off at 5. (Don't need constant supervision.)
V	Yes, in mustering work.	In fencing, bore work—knock-off when they get tired.	In mustering—one must have them.
VI	No.	Unreliable, pampered by Welfare (gets boys from Jay Creek).	Sometimes on stock work.

APPENDIX (Continued)

No. of Station	5. In your opinion, are Aborigines more valuable and productive workers than whites?	6. If you feel that Aborigines fall short of the mark, can you say why and in what respects?	7. If you feel Aborigines superior in value and productivity, can you say why and in what respects?
VII	In individual cases, yes.	Need continuous supervision, cruel on equipment.	Sometimes less supervision on stock work than jackeroos.
VIII	Good trackers but unreliable.	Not interested in work, spoilt by handouts, no mechanical abilities.	As trackers only.
IX	Mustering on a par with whites.	Can't work out stages of a cattle project, e.g. moving, no mechanical abilities.	Nil.
X	Yes, on track work, horses; excellent while supervised.	Need supervision.	Only tracking, horse work; can fence better in mid-summer heat.
XI	Yes, in relation to their knowledge of the local country.	No sense of responsibility (corrobores more important).	See answer to Question 6.
XII	Better at tracking — not as conscientious, only understand simple instructions.	Not conscientious, can't understand instructions, 1 good white = 3-4 Aborigines.	Only in tracking.

XIII	Know the country, better in the bush; do a good job.	Not as reliable.	Good mechanical ability (some).
XIV	Every bit as good as whites if supervised and no-hopers eliminated.	Need supervision, can't understand written instructions or reports.	Better at repetitive work, at tracking (but only if white there to interpret and utilise the skill).
XV	No.	Less incentive, most need supervision all the time, unreliable.	Older men good on bush work, stock work, trackers, but not young generation.
XVI	Have not got better skills than whites.	Need supervision but I am tolerant of their mistakes.	They shower every day and are cleaner than whites.
XVII	Yes, in bushcraft and tracking but they have to be taught. Good at pumping, can maintain engines.	Can be replaced by whites in 3 to 1 ratio. Aborigines can't be trained.	Better in bushcraft and tracking.
XVIII	No.	Can't work on their own, need constant supervision, illiterate.	Perhaps in yardwork and branding.
XIX	No, blacks have got worse.	Don't know anything about stock work. They are a lot of trouble and worry.	Can rely on boreman some of the time without supervision.
XX	Less valuable.	Unreliable, need constant supervision.	No — need too much supervision, even on mustering.

APPENDIX (Continued)

No. of Station	5. In your opinion, are Aborigines more valuable and productive workers than whites?	6. If you feel that Aborigines fall short of the mark, can you say why and in what respects?	7. If you feel Aborigines superior in value and productivity, can you say why and in what respects?
XXI	Climatically more adapted, less trouble with sex life, less likely to get lost.	Irresponsible with equipment, cruel with stock, no thought for tomorrow.	See answer to Question 5.
XXII	Two blacks I have are better than average white.	Need supervision, haven't had experience, can't do their work properly.	They (the 2?) know the country, the horses, good trackers. Will do a good job if treated properly, but can only be left alone for one day.
XXIII	Individually some are more productive but they are a small percentage.	Majority irresponsible, different values, time meaning less.	Knowledge of country and location of water-holes, some (2 families) fully reliable.
XXIV	No.	Need good supervision, then you can't beat them. Lazy, don't seem to respond to better treatment.	Odd one will shine — hold his own with best of them.

XXV	Knowledge of the country, tracking of cattle and horses.	Lack of initiative, reliability and responsibility. Can't be left alone for half a day but there are exceptions.	First rate as <i>bush</i> stockmen. Some can build fences and yards.
XXVI	In amongst cattle — Johnson would be supreme. But generally — no.	Lack of responsibility; have let station down badly several times. A few can go a week without supervision.	Many are good stockmen but horse murderers.
XXVII	No.	Can't take responsibility. No work continuity.	No.
XXVIII	No.	Apart from cattle work, inexperienced. Not as good at branding or yard building as whites.	Knowledge of country. As good as whites at chasing a bull.
XXIX	Yes, 4 (out of 10) who would not be replaced.	Not prepared to work. Money makes no difference. Even the four good ones unreliable and need supervision.	Four are good stockmen.
XXX	No.	Not worth two bob off a horse. Unreliable; can't be left for 3 days.	When led they are excellent. Can only trust one in charge of a camp.